

Co-operation, the IMS, and Ventures (CIV)

Goal

The overarching goal of the event is for the team to communicate, plan, build, and finish a fully functional civilisation. Players will learn to plan builds, build farms, construct essential settlement buildings, and how to do so under a loose, but existing, time constraint. Players will also develop, within the IMS community, stronger relationships which I envision will continue after this event.

The administrative goal of this event is for the IMS to regain control of event hosting after the failures of IMS: TSE, for organisers to “learn by doing”, and hopefully regain activity.

Organisation

This event will be run in a sessions-based format – meaning the event server will be offline during all other times. This will allow players to have planning time in-between sessions, co-operate much easier as everyone will be online during sessions, and make sure no substantial progress is made where the rest of the team could not catch up on.

Sessions also has the added benefit of making activity more concentrated over a shorter period of time, giving the impression of a livelier event.

The organising team for the event must not give mixed signals to players. If an organiser is unsure of something, they must not give false information. The worst thing that can happen is confusion, which causes players to feel like the event is out of reach for them.

The target player count for this event shall be 6-10.

Investigation

Events in the IMS are not simply for fun, but also interweave investigations, hypotheses, and theories in an approachable, manageable, and enjoyable way for all Minecraft players.

This event shall investigate **whether playing Minecraft for one’s own satisfaction and enjoyment is sufficient to create a finalised and complete work.** i.e., are the players sufficiently driven by their shared goal of building a complete civilisation without any external feedback (replicating the environment of real Minecraft servers,) and without any ultimate goal (e.g., a war between two civilisations) to continue to 1. have fun during the event, and 2. actually complete the civilisation?

Player satisfaction shall be measured using a five-point Likert scale of agreement (strongly agree, agree, etc.), asking the following questions to each player after each session:

1. I enjoyed this session.
2. I did not think about anything other than what I was doing.
3. I was aware of how much I did or did not enjoy this session.
4. Time flew by during this session.
5. I was disappointed when the session ended.

6. I feel a sense of accomplishment after this session.

After each session, the number of missions the team completed should be recorded. If they completed things aside from the listed missions, also note these down as a rough image of the amount of tasks completed.

Missions

Each session of the event will be for working towards the following goals:

1. basic food production, and temporary shelter,
2. acquiring armour and gear,
3. building a small village with houses
4. building a decorated and functional villager trading hall,
5. acquiring enchanted gear and armour,
6. building various resource farms,
7. planning a full city build for the civilisation (in-game),
8. building the planned infrastructure, including any redstone circuitry and decorations,
9. creating other important farms, buildings, and outposts for the civilisation,
10. creating a transportation system around the central island,
11. going to the nether and collecting its associated resources, and
12. finally, creating a dedicated room for nether-specific jobs, such as a potion room.

All players will be shown the entire list of missions to help them prepare and plan with more ease – they do not need to be followed to the letter, as they are simply for guidance. Some goals may be up to interpretation – for example, mission 1, “basic food production”, may be a rudimentary wheat farm – however players are encouraged to, and in the spirit of the event, should, simulate a real civilisation, decorate buildings, and plan for the future.

No reward is given for completing these missions, and organisers should not compliment players on their work.

End of event

The end of the event will begin once the team is satisfied that they have finished mission 12, and that they believe the civilisation is complete. After this, the team will be put in creative mode, and one hour of free time shall begin. During this time, a series of short interviews shall follow with each player, conducted by organisers and reporters of the IMSPD.

After the free time is up, the world download will be shared on the IMS, and an announcement to be made to officially end the event.

Content during the event

During the planning stages of IMS: TSE, Turtle (turtle2770) mentioned intentions of creating weekly (or regular) videos during the event, which will help to recruit more members outside the IMS to join the event – and potentially get involved with the IMS more generally.

Although this event will benefit from a similar plan, it was clear from the beginning of the event that this would be entirely unsustainable. With no one having the time, effort, or resources to record and edit videos per week or fortnightly, IMS: TSE had to resort to Reddit posts for promotion – this, however, also failed due to low engagement of posts.

This event must generate content during the event to take advantage of the ongoing excitement to drive recruitment to the event and the IMS. The content must be relatively low-effort, require relatively little time, and be able to be created by anyone.

The main source of this shall be social media posts on Reddit, Twitter, or otherwise, detailing the goal of the event and why people should join. This should also be done at least two weeks before the start of the event, and continue until the start date.

The Publishing Department (IMSPD) shall also publish Substack articles after each session of the event, discussing what players did, including some quotations and thoughts of the players, and what will come next. The article may also discuss how people may get involved during the event, which will most likely be observing or helping to create content for the event.

YouTube videos may be made after the event by IMS content creators, but this is highly resource intensive and time consuming – this is not directly encouraged.

Content after the event

Players are encouraged to write about their thoughts of the event either informally as a Discord message, semi-formally in the #free-write channel, or more formally as an essay or opinion piece. The IMSPD shall also focus on publishing articles related to the event to promote the work of the IMS.